

On The Right Side Of The Law

Q I am building a PC for myself for the first time and have a copy of Windows XP that came with a laptop that I bought last year. Is it legal to install this version on my new PC with the same CD key as my laptop? Also, can I make a recovery CD for my home-built computer like the CDs you get when you buy certain branded computer systems?

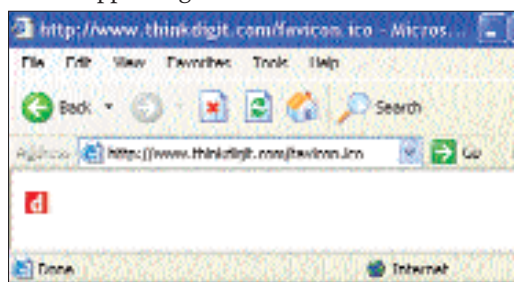
Nikhil Vaidya

A The copy of Windows XP that came with your laptop is only for use with that laptop. According to the EULA, you are legally entitled to install Windows XP if you completely remove it from the laptop and then install it on

another computer, but using it on two machines is a strict no-no. The only solution for you is to purchase a second copy of XP.

A recovery CD restores a PC to its factory-fresh state. This won't take into account any programs you have installed in addition to Windows. A better solution is to use a program such as Acronis TrueImage from www.acronis.com, or PowerQuest Drive Image from www.powerquest.com. These programs make a complete copy or image of your hard drive, which you can store on one or more CDs. You can re-apply this image to your PC to restore it to a fully-working state following a crash. What's more, the image can even be updated to take account of any new programs you have installed.

sooner or later it will be pushed out of the cache by newer content. As long as the site uses the simple favicon.ico technique, you can prevent this disappearing act.



Save the icon of your favourite Web site

Open Internet Explorer, click the Address bar, and type the site's domain name followed by a slash and favicon.ico—for example, www.thinkdigit.com/favicon.ico. Your browser should now display the desired icon. Right-click the icon and choose Save Picture As to save a copy of the icon on your own computer. Next, right-click the URL shortcut or Favorite and choose Properties. Click the Change Icon button, click the Browse button, and select your saved icon. This one won't disappear on you!

Friendly Transfer Please

Q I have Windows XP and a broadband connection. I have a registered Web site where I wish to upload files so my friends can access them. I have tried various FTP programs, but have found them really confusing. Is there any easy way to upload to Web sites?

Malkit Singh

A Windows XP supports FTP, so you can connect to your Webspace as you would any to folder on your hard drive.

Make sure you have your FTP address at hand along with your username and password before clicking on Start > My Network Places. When the window opens, click "Add A Network Place", then click Next. You can work your way through the Wizard, entering your FTP address and username. When you double-click the new icon that gets created, you will be connected to your Webspace and be

prompted for your password.

You can cut out many of the steps of the Wizard by entering the following information when asked to enter the Internet or Network Address: `ftp://username:password@ftpaddress`. Here, replace "username", "password", and "ftpaddress" with your actual login information, and a new shortcut will be created for you in one step.

CoffeeCup Free FTP (<http://www.coffeecup.com/free-ftp/>), Free FTP (<http://www.brandyware.com/free.htm>), and Core FTP Lite (<http://www.coreftp.com/>) are some free FTP tools you may wish to try.

SP2: Service Pack Or Space Pincher?

Q After I installed XP's Service Pack 2, I found that I've lost a substantial amount of disk space. I don't think SP2 requires that much disk space. How can I reclaim at least some of it?

Mohit Sharma

A You're right—Windows XP SP2 does not require all that much space on its own, but it does leave behind a lot of files that you really don't need.

The first, usual culprit is a very large Restore Point in case the System Restore feature is active on your installation of Windows XP. You can remove all but the most recent Restore Point quite easily. Go to Start > All Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Disk Cleanup. Select Drive C and click OK. Then click on the More Options tab. Next, click on the Clean Up button at the bottom and click Yes when asked if you want to delete all but the most recent Restore Point.

You can also remove the uninstallation information for SP2. This, too, is quite simple. All you need to do is delete the NTServicePackUninstall folder, which you will find in C:\Windows. If you can't find the folder, select Folder Options from the Windows Tools menu, and when the dialog box appears, click on the View tab. Select the option to "Show hidden files and folders", and the folder should become visible.

You could also find that you have a large folder called C:\Windows\Software Distribution\Download, which, too, can be deleted. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!